

Memory narratives

What this tool produces · *A curated collection of oral histories, personal stories, and emotional mappings that translate the intangible cultural memory of a community into a tangible planning asset.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Heritage

Social / User

Preparing the workshop · *Memory narratives*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Treating the whispered memories and local legends of everyday people as sacred data, proving that a city's true foundation is built on human stories, not just concrete.

Evidence we produce

A curated collection of oral histories, personal stories, and emotional mappings that translate the intangible cultural memory of a community into a tangible planning asset.

Duration & Material

Duration · 2 to 4 months of community workshops and documentation

Material · Audio recorders, printed maps, digital storytelling platforms

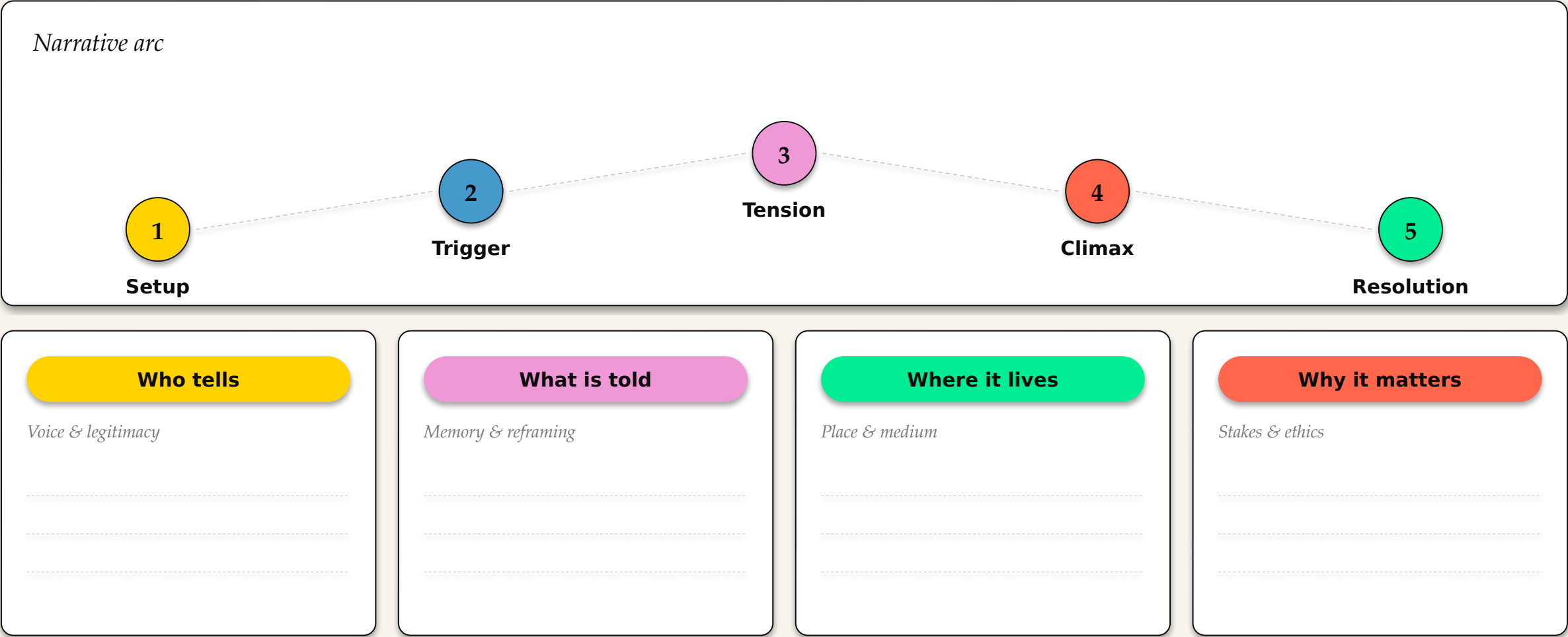
Reference case

In Alexandria, Egypt, the assessment of cultural memory as urban identity demonstrated that treating urban heritage as an active carrier of shared narratives is essential. Planning processes that actively document and integrate these historical narratives succeed in celebrating heritage as a living expression of collective identity rather than an obstacle to development.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Narrative arc · who tells, what, where, why

Duration
2 to 4 months of community workshops and documentation



Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.